

1. **Academic Year:** 2026/27
2. **Course Code:** CCGL9011
3. **Course Title:** Media in the Age of Globalization
4. **Course Description:**
 In this course, students will examine the role of the media in shaping the global and local societies, as well as the ways how growing access to information fosters knowledge sharing and citizen participation in public affairs and creates social problems such as privacy infringement, misinformation, and polarization. The students will explore if the global media really changes the power structure of information flow, production, and dissemination or actually reinforces the imbalance. Do the media technologies amount to an individual's emancipation or serve as another form of exploitation? What is the role of the media in Hong Kong, China, and the rest of the world? In a multipolar cultural world, how do citizens contribute to the conversation on local and global issues? The course will also reflect on critical social values such as the freedom of expression, information, privacy, transparency, and investigate the impact of the social media, artificial intelligence and blockchain technology.

 This course is designed as a “flipped classroom” mode. Students are required to prepare and complete pre-class activities (reading, videos, and research) before the class and participate in weekly in-class activities and tutorials.
5. **Assessment Ratio:** 100% coursework
6. **Offer Semester:** First Semester
Day of Teaching: Wednesday
7. **Offering Department(s):**
 School of Future Media - 100%
8. **Course Coordinator:**
 Professor K.W. Fu
 School of Future Media
 Tel: 3917 1643
 Email: kwfu@hku.hk
9. **Teacher(s):**
 Professor K.W. Fu
 School of Future Media
 Tel: 3917 1643 Email: kwfu@hku.hk
10. **Study Load**

Activities	Number of hours
Classroom sessions	24
Tutorials	10
Preparing materials and questions for discussion	46
Assessment: Group project	45
Assessment: Essay writing	10
Total:	135
<i>[A CC course generally aims for a workload of 120-140 hours.]</i>	

11. **Course Learning Outcomes and Alignment with Common Core Programme Learning Outcomes**

Course Learning Outcomes – On completing the course, students will be able to:		Alignment with the Common Core Programme Learning Outcome(s)
1.	Demonstrate basic understanding of the global media system, in light of contending political, cultural and economic paradigms.	CC PLO(s):1,2,3
2.	Demonstrate basic understanding of the role of technology in the development of the global media system.	CC PLO(s):1,2,3
3.	Identify and demonstrate basic understanding of the mechanisms by which governments, and business interests influence the framing of news.	CC PLO(s):1,2,3
4.	Demonstrate basic understanding of the role of and impact of social media on the global dynamics of information flow and exchange.	CC PLO(s):1,2,3,4
5.	Identify and analyze key risks and opportunities in the global media	CC PLO(s):1,2,3,4
6.	Demonstrate understanding of the issues of freedom of expression, privacy and transparency in relation to the global media.	CC PLO(s):1,2,3,4

12. **Assessment Tasks**

Assessment Method	Details of Assignment	Weighting	Alignment with Course Learning Outcome(s)
In-class quizzes	In-class quiz	25	CLOs: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6
Class participation	Participation in in-class group activities	10	CLOs: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6
Group project	Group project on a course topic.	40	CLOs: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6
Individual essay	Mid-term essay	25	CLOs: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6

13. **Course Content and Topics**

1. Introduction
2. Media Framing
3. Journalism and globalization
4. News and Media ecosystem
5. Technology, media, and society
6. Decentralization: Digital activism and Blockchain
Reading Week
7. Freedom of expression and Internet censorship in a global world
8. Digital media, surveillance society, privacy, and transparency
9. Misinformation, Disinformation and Propaganda
10. Mobile media and globalization

- 11. Soft power and digital diplomacy
- 12. Big Data, AI, and Future Technologies

14. **Required Reading**

No required textbook. Readings and video materials will be assigned weekly. Students are strongly recommended to read widely and stay up to date on current events and major local and global developments of media and technology.

15. **Additional Course Information**

(e.g. course policy, penalty for late assignments, e.t.c.)

Students are expected to attend ALL classes and read/watch ALL assigned texts/videos before each class. Plagiarism is considered as serious offence and the offender will be dropped from the class with a failing grade. Please check HKU guideline of plagiarism <http://www.hku.hk/plagiarism/>.

Make sure the core intellectual part of the submission, no matter individual or group work, are yours. Generative AI or other supporting technologies are not supposed to replace your intellectual contribution to your course submission. Violations will be considered as cheating and will result in a failed mark in individual or group assignment or even entire course;

Students are required to document clearly and in detail of what you used Generative AI for, the full name of the tool used (with version number), how it was used (the prompt you use and the results you got from the prompt), the reason(s) for use, and the justification(s) for your core intellectual contribution.

You are responsible for the quality of the information sources. Don't take anything for granted. This is your duty to verify all the information in your submission. Cite only reliable sources or academic publications;

The instructor reserves the right to change the assignments, the week-to-week schedule of class content, and any other aspects of the course.

All assignments submitted to Moodle will be considered final, and no subsequent changes will be accepted. Each student is solely responsible for ensuring their submissions are complete, correct and relevant to the assignment.

CCGL9011 Media in the Age of Globalization

Grade Descriptors

	A	B	C	D	F
1. Demonstrate basic understanding of the global media system, in light of contending political, cultural and economic paradigms.	Sophisticated understanding of the global media system.	Clear understanding of the global media system.	Understanding of the global media system.	Bare minimum understanding of the global media system.	Little or no understanding of the global media system.
2. Demonstrate basic understanding of the role of technology in the development of the global media system.	Sophisticated understanding of the role of technology in the development of the global media system.	Clear understanding of the role of technology in the development of the global media system.	Understanding of the role of technology in the development of the global media system.	Bare minimum understanding of the role of technology in the development of the global media system.	Little or no understanding of the role of technology in the development of the global media system.
3. Identify and demonstrate basic understanding of the mechanisms by which governments and business interests influence the framing of news.	High awareness of the mechanisms by which governments and business interests influence the framing of news.	Moderate awareness of the mechanisms by which governments and business interests influence the framing of news.	Some awareness of the mechanisms by which governments and business interests influence the framing of news.	Bare minimum the mechanisms by which governments and business interests influence the framing of news.	Little or no awareness of the mechanisms by which governments and business interests influence the framing of news.
4. Demonstrate basic understanding of the role of and the impact of social media on the global dynamics of information flow and exchange.	Sophisticated understanding of the role of and the impact of social media on the global dynamics of information flow and exchange.	Clear understanding of the role of and the impact of social media on the global dynamics of information flow and exchange.	Understanding of the role of and the impact of social media on the global dynamics of information flow and exchange.	Bare minimum understanding of the role of and the impact of social media on the global dynamics of information flow and exchange.	Little or no understanding of the role of and the impact of social media on the global dynamics of information flow and exchange.
5. Identify and analyze key risks and opportunities in the global media	High awareness of key risks and opportunities in the global media	Moderate awareness of key risks and opportunities in the global media	Some awareness of key risks and opportunities in the global media	Bare minimum awareness of key risks and opportunities in the global media	Partial or no awareness of key risks and opportunities in the global media
6. Demonstrate understanding of the issues of freedom of expression, privacy and transparency in relation to the global media	Thorough and in-depth understanding of the issues of freedom of expression, privacy and transparency in relation to the global media.	Thorough understanding of the issues of freedom of expression, privacy and transparency in relation to the global media.	Basic understanding of the issues of freedom of expression, privacy and transparency in relation to the global media.	Bare minimum understanding of the issues of freedom of expression, privacy and transparency in relation to the global media.	Partial or no understanding of the issues of freedom of expression, privacy and transparency in relation to the global media.